

Forest Establishment

Land Sciences

May, 2026



**SE
TU**

Ollscoil
Teicneolaíochta
an Oirdheiscirt

South East
Technological
University

Forest Establishment (A13104)

Short Title: Forest Establishment
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Land Sciences
Cluster Forestry
Author ABOOTH
Credits 5

Level: Introductory

Description of Module / Aims

This course is designed to give students an overview of forestry establishment practices. This will include seed collection, through to sowing in a forest nursery, and from there onto the planting site and all the establishment practices associated with it. Students will learn to carry out forest development plans and planting plans. They will also attain some of the necessary practical skills needed for establishing a forest, such as formative shaping, planting and weed control.

Programmes

FORS-0001 BSc in Forestry (WD_SFORS_D)

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Indicative Content

- Seed and seed procurement
- Seed processing and storage
- Forest nursery practice
- Lifting storing handling plants
- Forest establishment practices: cultivation, drainage, species selection, fencing, vegetation control, stocking
- Site description, mapping
- Formative shaping of broadleaves

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Discuss the different methods of seed collection, storage and use, for the main forest species in Ireland.
2. Summarise the main components and operations of a forest nursery.
3. Explain the main establishment procedures used in plantation forestry.
4. Demonstrate the ability to assess, describe and map forest sites.
5. Demonstrate some practical skills associated with the establishment phase of a plantation.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lectures.
- Independent learning.
- Field trips.
- Demonstrations.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Final Written Examination	50%	1,2,3
Continuous Assessment	50%	
Assignment	50%	4,5

Assessment Criteria

- <40%:** Very limited knowledge and understanding of the subject matter. Lacking in technical ability/skill and understanding to carry out assessments. Failure to meet the objectives of assessments. Unable to carry out or submit independent study and research. Unable to present written work with attention to correct formatting, grammar and spelling.
- 40%-49%:** Demonstrate a limited knowledge of the subject matter. Show some technical ability/skill in carrying out and reporting on assessments. Attempt made to meet objectives and carry out independent study and research. Final result lacks balance and arguments undeveloped. Can present written work correctly formatted with minor grammar and spelling errors only.
- 50%-59%:** Demonstrate satisfactory general knowledge of the main issues within the subject. Logically and competently carry out assessments. Satisfactory handling and awareness in carrying out independent study and research. Reporting and projects adequately structured and referenced.
- 60%-69%:** Demonstrate sound knowledge of the subject matter. Show ability to analyse and logically argue in an effective and mature style. Demonstrate initiative and the ability to criticise methods used and appreciation of experimental design and current knowledge limitations when carrying out assessments. Projects and reporting coherent and soundly structured illustrating wide and in depth reading on subject coupled with the proper use of references.
- 70%-100%:** Demonstrate authoritative handling of complex material and a highly developed and extensive understanding of the subject. Provide well focused analysis and convincing argument on the subject. Demonstrate imaginative approach, excellent technical ability, awareness, and aptitude in carrying out and reporting on assessments. Show initiative, individual thought, and enthusiasm in self study and independent learning.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	24	
Field Trips	24	
Independent Learning	87	

Essential Material

- Aldhous, J.R. and W.L Mason. _Forest Nursery Practice_. UK: HMSO, 1994.
- Forest Service, Anon. _Code of best forest practice-Ireland_. Ireland: Forest Service, 2000.
- Forest Service, Anon. _Forestry Schemes Manual_. Ireland: Forest Service, 2014.
- Gordon, A.G. _Seed manual for forest trees_. UK: HMSO, 1992.
- Hibberd, B.G. _Forestry Practice_. 11th ed. UK: HMSO, 1991.
- Morgan, J.L. _Forest. Tree seedlings -best practice in supply, treatment and planting_. UK: HMSO, 1999.